In pairs, look at each of the lists below.

For each one:

- decide which word is the odd one out
- explain why it is the odd one out and what the other two have in common
- try to add one more choice in the blank space at the end of each row, but maintaining the same odd one out.

Number	Lists			Reasoning	Additional choice
1	the Earth	Pluto	Jupiter		
2	the Sun	the Pole star	Venus		
3	lunar month	year length	day length		
4	planets	constellations	satellites		
5	asteroids	meteors	comets		
6	Mercury	Mars	Neptune		
7	space probes	artificial satellites	the Moon		
8	space travel	global positioning system (GPS)	cartography (map making)		

© www.teachitscience.co.uk 2012

Suggested answers:

Number				Reasoning	Additional choice
1	the Earth	**Pluto**	Jupiter	Earth and Jupiter are planets in the solar system. Pluto is classed as a dwarf planet.	Mercury
2	the Sun	the Pole star	**Venus**	The Sun and the Pole star are both stars. Venus is one of the eight planets within the solar system.	Vega
3	**lunar month**	year length	day length	Year length and day length are caused by the motion of a the Earth, i.e. its orbit and rotation on its axis. A lunar month is the time the moon takes to pass through its phases.	orbit, rotation, night
4	planets	**constellations**	satellites	Planets and satellites are found within a solar system. Constellations are patterns we can see in the stars.	asteroids
5	asteroids	**meteors**	comets	Asteroids and comets are minor solar system bodies that orbit the Sun. Meteors come into the Earth's atmosphere and burn up (shooting stars).	dwarf planet
6	Mercury	Mars	**Neptune**	Mercury and Mars are inner planets. Neptune is an outer planet.	Earth, Venus
7	space probes	artificial satellites	**the Moon**	Artificial satellites and the Moon (a natural satellite) orbit the Earth. Space probes travel to other planets.	natural satellite

© www.teachitscience.co.uk 2012

8	**space travel**	global positioning system (GPS)	cartography (map making)	GPS and cartography are uses of artificial satellites. Space travel has been achieved using spacecraft such as the Shuttle.	communications, weather forecasting, surface observations, spying